

AE4238: Aero Engine Technology

Engine Inlets-I: The main functions

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What will we learn in this lecture

- What are Aircraft Inlets
- Some of design criteria
- Examples

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Engine Intake



Intake design considerations

Aerodynamics

Stealth

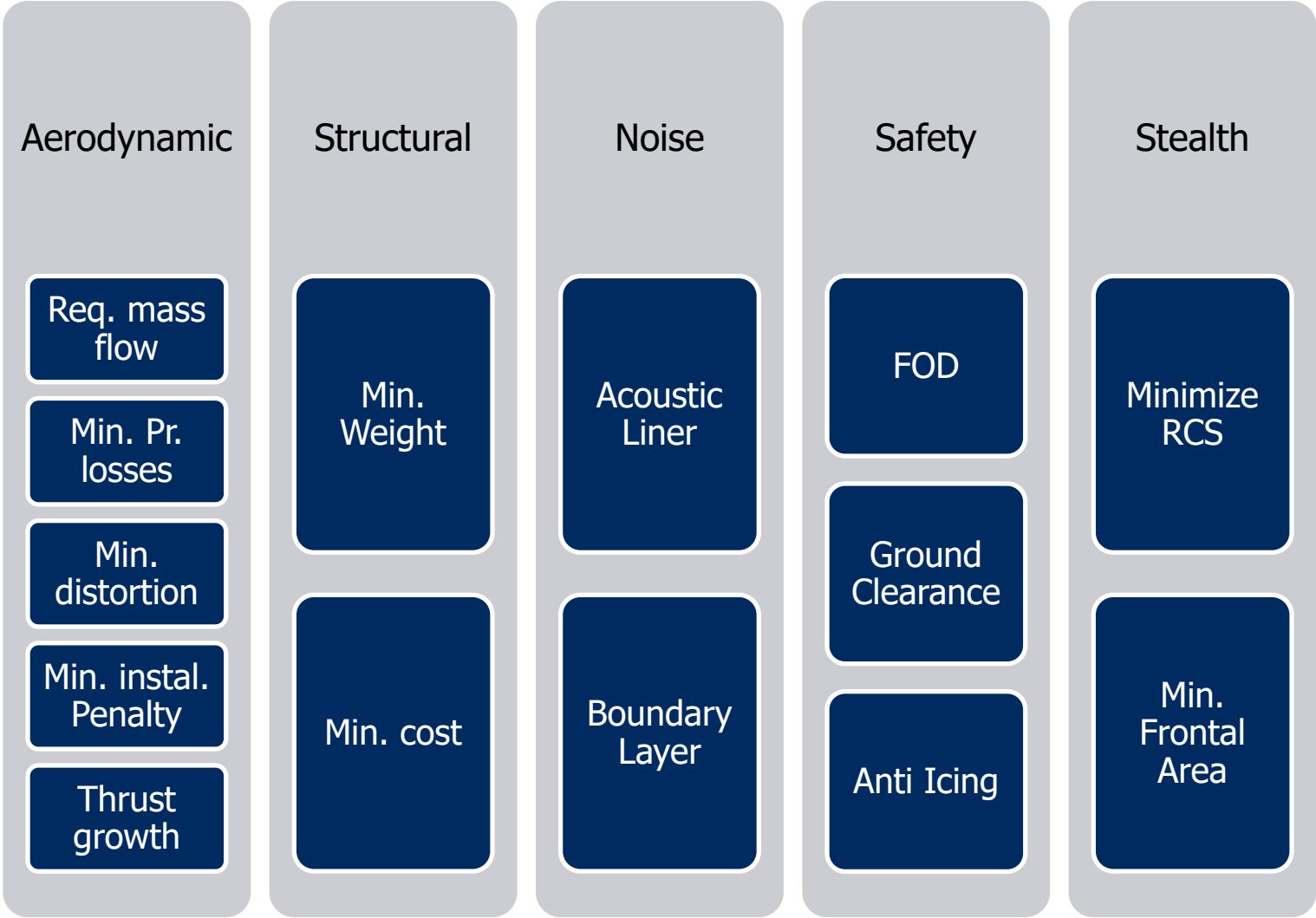
Structural

Safety

Noise



Intake design considerations



Foreign object damage



Jet engine intake

- Essentially a fluid flow duct whose task is to process airflow in a way that ensures the engine functions properly
- Provide adequate amount of uniform flow
- Cruising: conversion of E_{kin} into E_{pot} (pressure)
- Ram compression / “Ram recovery”
- Supersonic vs. subsonic intake
- Subsonic inlets are dominated by the boundary layer behavior.
- Supersonic inlets are dominated by the shock structure
- From 1D compressible aerodynamics
- $dA/A = (M^2 - 1) * (dV/V)$
- “Bellmouth” intake (test bed/stationary)

Louvers Engine Intake (Mig 29)

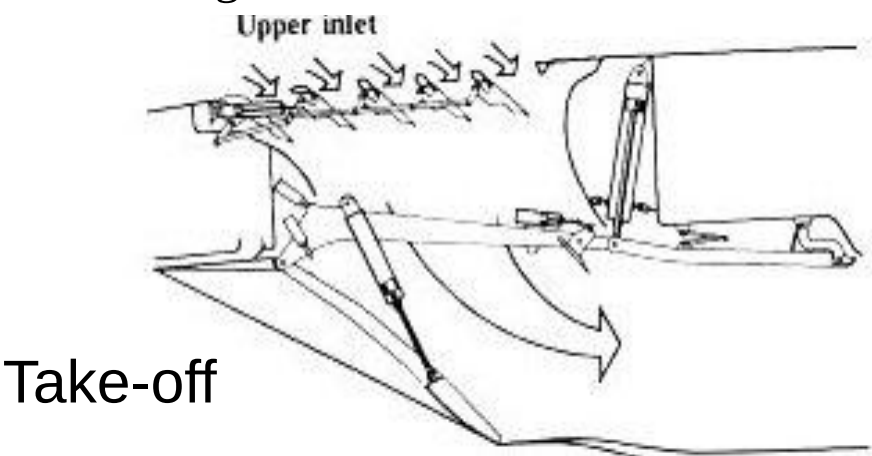


Mig 29 FOD protection

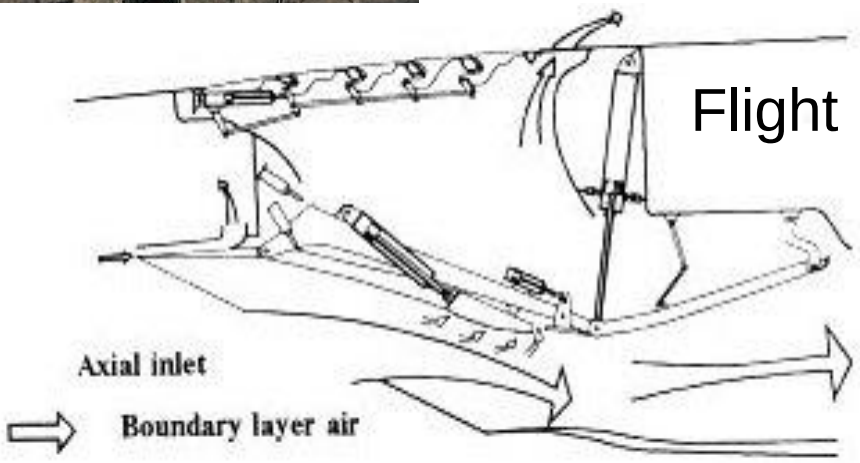
Inlet door (down) with porous surfaces for boundary layer bleed



Auxiliary inlet doors used during take-off



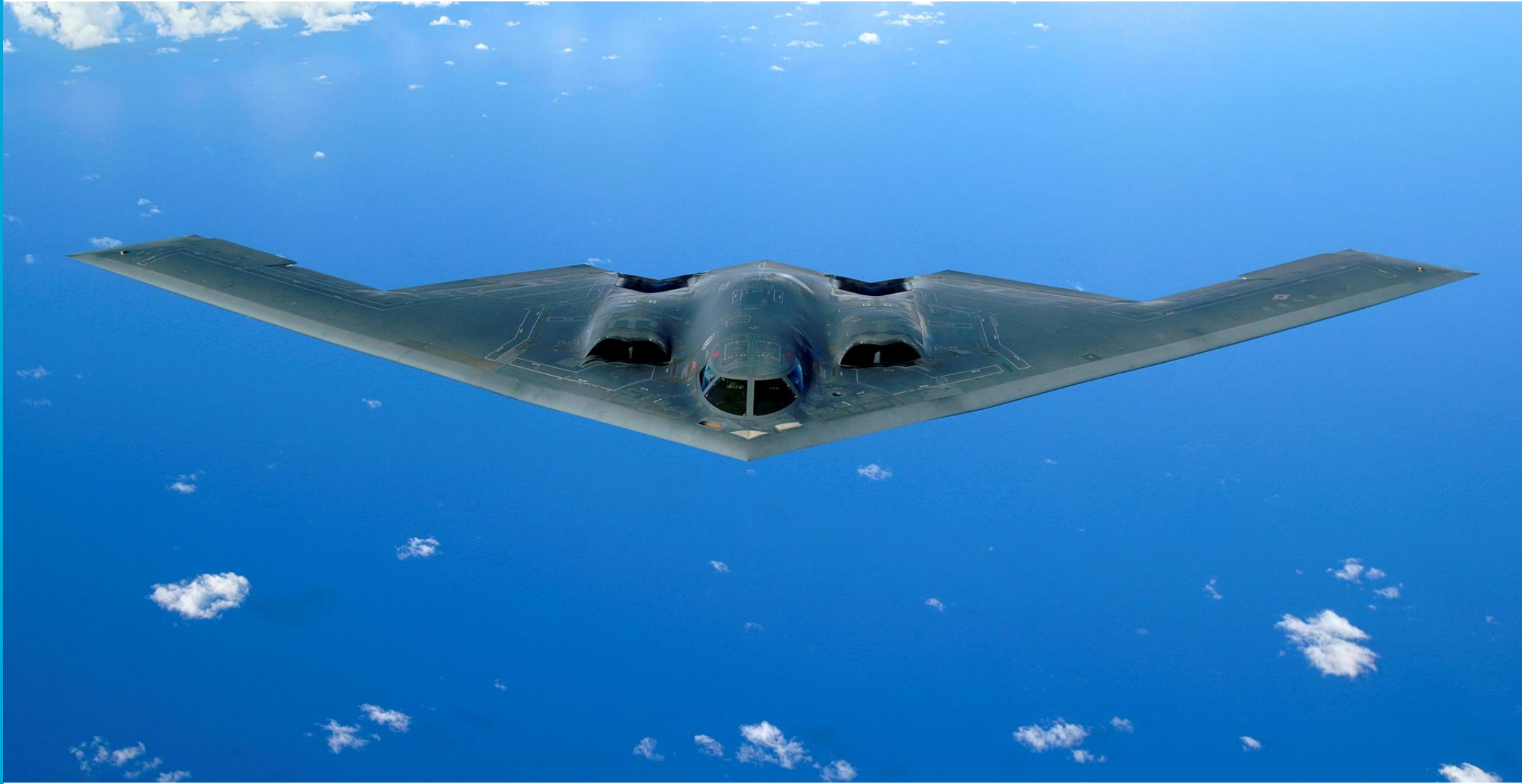
Take-off



Over the wing Intake (F117A)



Shielded Engine Intake (B2)



Minimum Ground Clearance

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Boeing 737-800 NG



Boeing 737-800 Max

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Subsonic inlet (GE90)

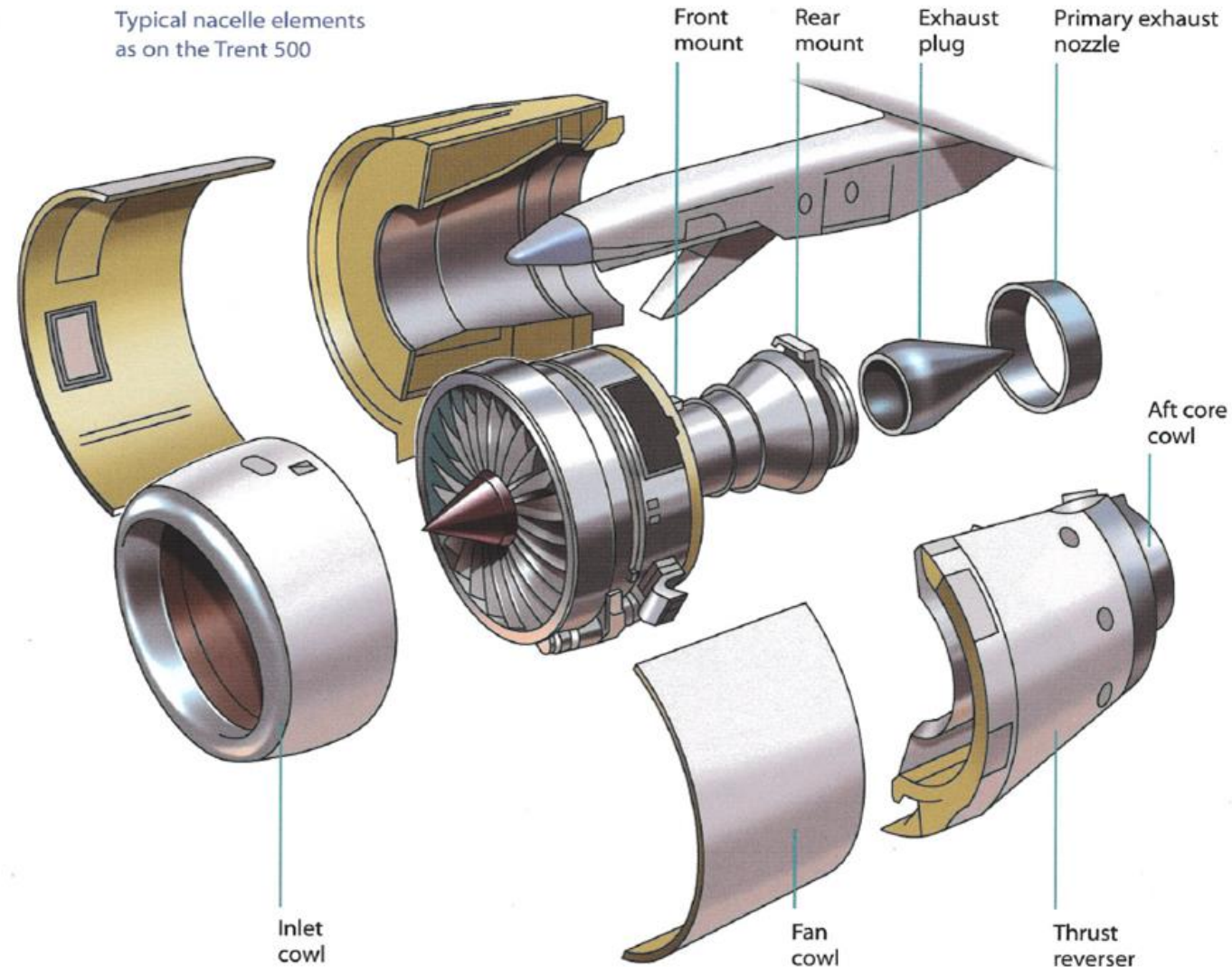


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Typical nacelle of a commercial engine

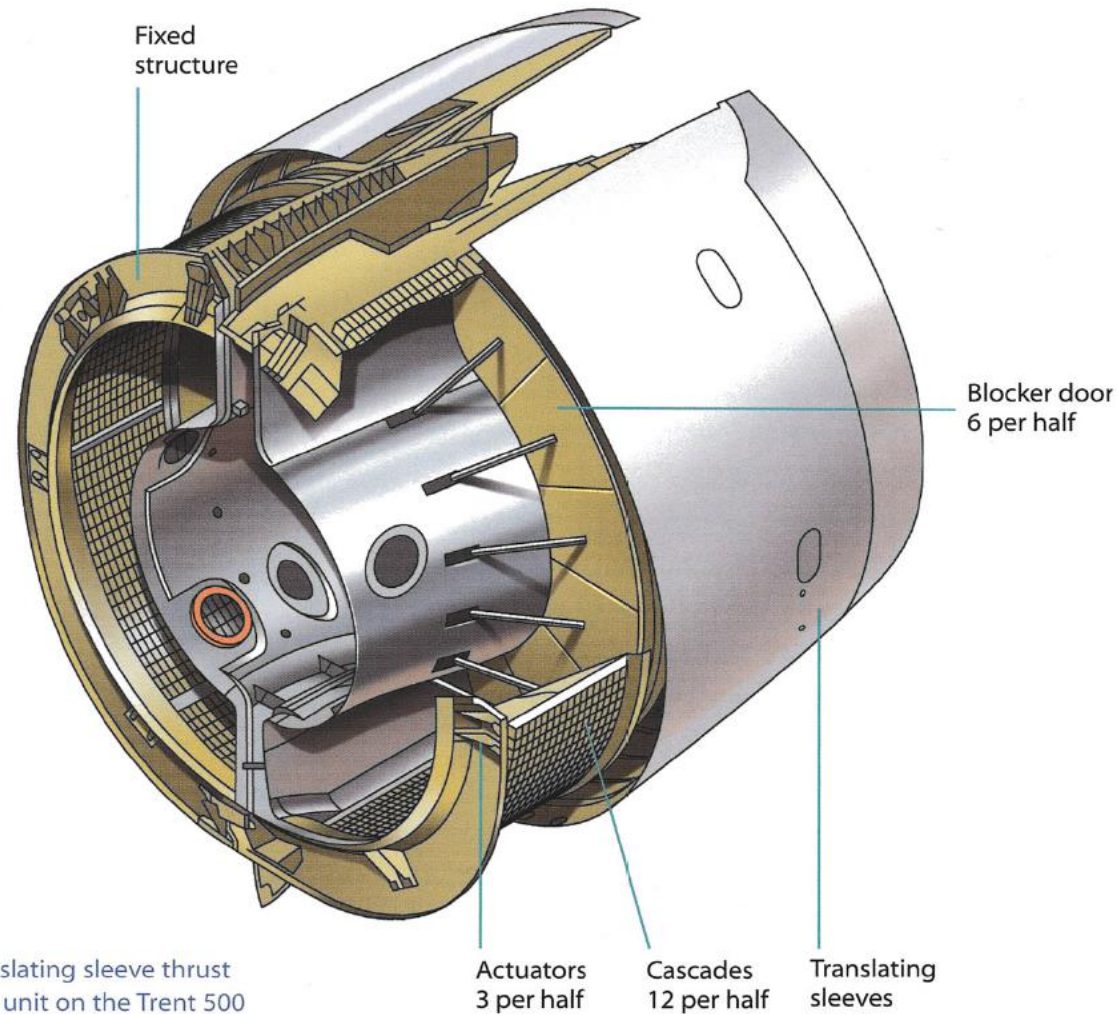
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Source: The Jet Engine, Rolls Royce PLC, 2006

Thrust reversal

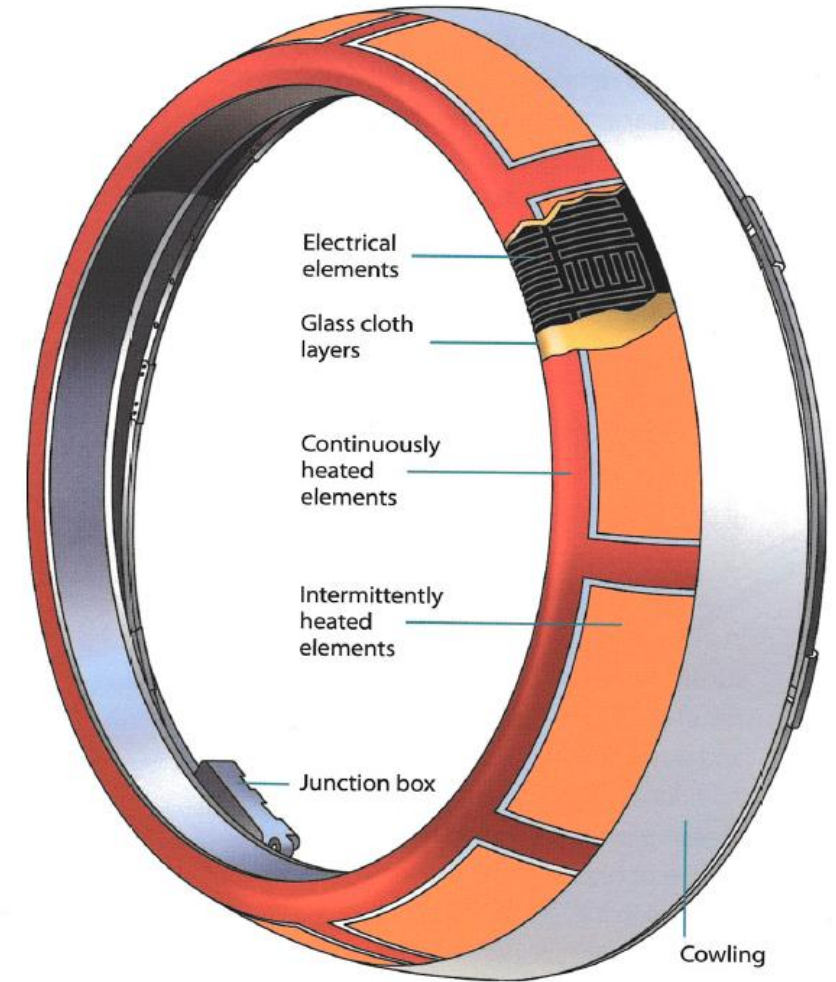
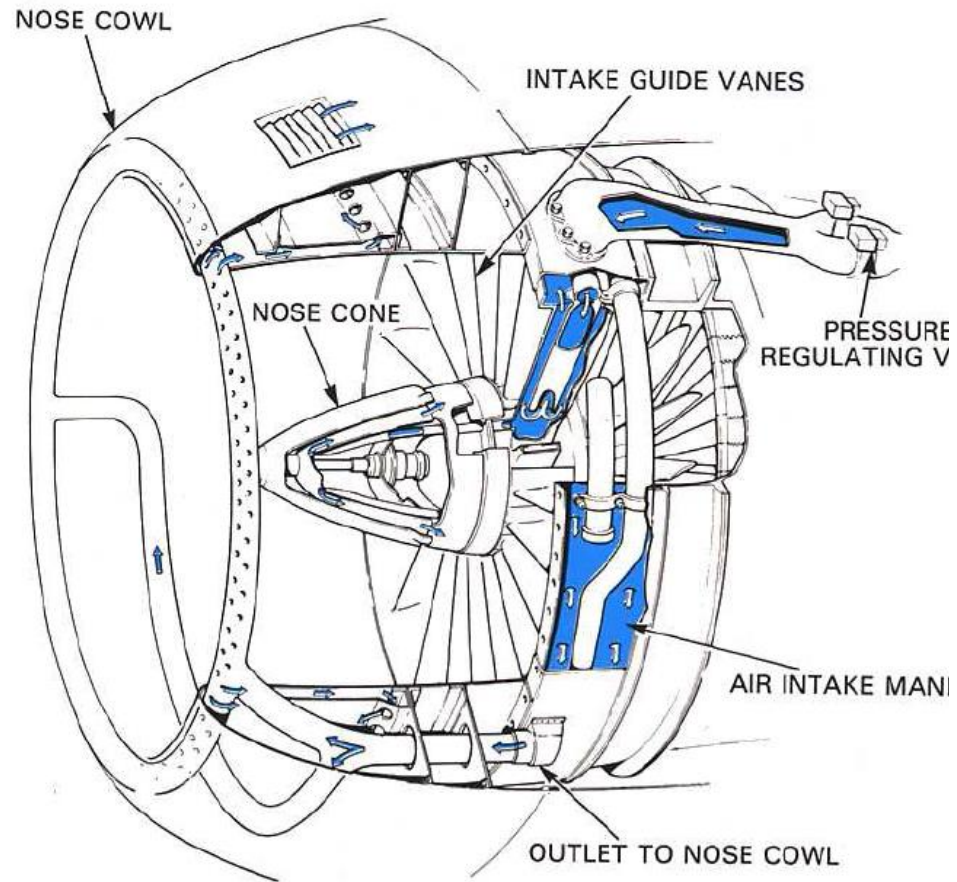
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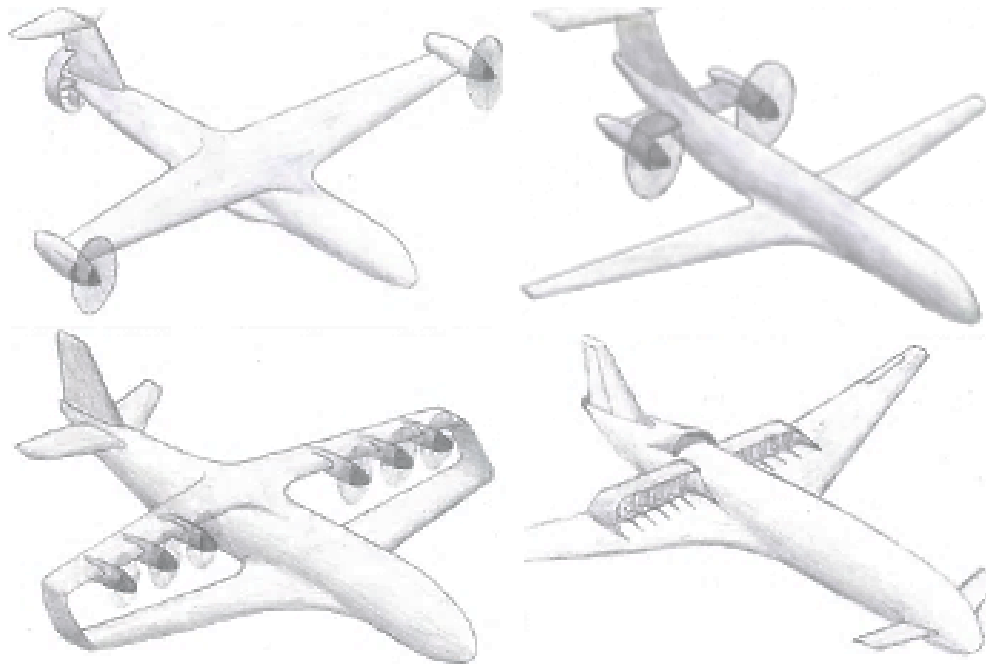
The translating sleeve thrust reverser unit on the Trent 500

Engine Intake

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Thank You



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